CRESCENDO
SINGING FOR JOY
Crescendo Community Chorus

and

FRIENDS OF THE MISSISSIPPI RIVER
Friends of the Mississippi River

PRESENT

A CELEBRATION OF THE MISSISSIPPI RIVER

Randal A. Buikema, Conductor
Franco Holder, Accompanist
Heid Erdrich, Minneapolis Poet Laureate 2024

Thursday, May 15, 2025 @7:30 PM
Nicollet Island -Mississippi River

www.crescendochorus.org

DeLaSalle High School
1 DeLaSalle Drive
Minneapolis

Free Admission

https://fmr.org/

CRESCENDO COMMUNITY CHORUS

We sing to experience the joy of blending voices and to unite singers and listeners through choral music, bringing harmony and beauty to our community.

Diane Alshouse
Janet Avery
Janice Barbee
Kelton Barr*
Shari Barr*
Tassi Bisers
Theresa Brinkhaus
Judy Broad
Katie Broich
Benjamin Brown
SaRoi Brown
Melissa Burton
Grace Bushard*
Amanda Carlson
Bridget Cerny*
Ann Cohen
Ben Cooper+
Wes Cutter
Ray Dillon
Nancy Duncan*
Elizabeth Dunn
Alix Dvorak
Kyle Erickson
Sarah Frazier
Val Garber*
Nancy Gaschott+*
Sandra Giovinazzo-Yates
Beth Gohdes
Alice Golter
Pat Gottschalk
Bonnie Gray*
Gail Griffin*
Marilyn Habermas-Scher
Vicky Hannemann*
Elaine Heisterkamp
Alice Hoelzer
Greg Hoelzer*
Marybeth Hoelzer*
Susan Holmen
Ramona Johnson*
Bill Jones
Bill Karns
Ann Kay+
Susan Keller*
Fawzia Khan
Jared Kieling*
Ellen Kluz+
Reid Knuttila
Karen Lehman
Geoff Lenox
Sam May
Anne McBean
Ginny McCarthy
Alisa Mendelsohn
Barbara Mueller
Krista Nelson
Ann O'Fallon
Mary Olson
Nora Page
Karen Parson*
Liz Permar*
Rita Peterson
Lawrence Pry*
Richard Rames
Jean Ramlow
Jim Ramnaraine+
Weld Ransom+
Phoebe Reinhart
Sarah Reinke
Lynn Richardson
Cheryl Ritenbaugh
Paul Rokke*
Dick Rueter
Michael Russelle*
Pat Ryan
Keira Scanlan
Susan Schultz+*
Daniel Shaw
Carol Siegel
Lisa Sinclair*
Gireesh Sinclair-Wood
Mary Singer
Doug Smalley
Lynne Stanley
Kristin Thompson
Mark Thompson
Greta Thorson
Margaret Tobin
Kristin Tout
Colleen TwoFeathers
Sam Vinitsky
Tina Wade
Cora Walsh
Patricia Ward
John Welsh*
Anna Wieser
Laurie Witzkowski
Judith Wright*
Ingrid Young

* Singer donors whose fee payment exceeded the suggested amount + Board member

Instrumentalists

Karen Kozak, violin
Aaron Barrett, cello
Philip Nusbaum, banjo
Charlie McCarron, guitar
Ann Marie McIntire, bass
Will Kemperman, percussion
Franco Holder, piano

HEID E. ERDRICH, Minneapolis Poet Laureate 2024

Heid Erdrich is a writer from North Dakota who curates art exhibits, teaches, researches, and collaborates with other artists. She is Ojibwe, enrolled at Turtle Mountain. Erdrich is the author of several poetry collections, and has received fellowships and awards from the Minnesota State Arts Board, the Loft Literary Center, The First People's Fund, and the Archibald Bush Foundation.

FRIENDS OF THE MISSISSIPPI RIVER

Friends of the Mississippi River (FMR) engages people to protect, restore and enhance the Mississippi River and its watershed in the Twin Cities region. FMR envisions a river accessible to all where water is clean and safe to drink, wildlife is abundant, and cultural treasures are protected.

PROGRAM

To the River – a visual art presentation

Joyce Lyon is an artist, curator, and teacher whose work focuses on the intersection of place and memory. For 20 years she has lived part-time in Umbria, near the Tiber River. The river's Roman history and her own experience inspired the drawings of To the River. She is Associate Professor of Art Emeritus at the University of Minnesota. She is represented by Groveland Gallery and Form+Content Gallery, Minneapolis.

Let the River Run — Music/lyrics by Carly Simon; arr., Craig Hella Johnson

Reading: Skins, Tones, Forms, Flows — Heid Erdrich

Down to the River to Pray — Traditional, arr., Sheldon Curry
Audience sings when invited

As I went down to the river to pray,
studyin' about that good ol' way,
and who shall wear the starry crown,
Good Lord, show me the way.

O lovers, let's go down,
let's go down, come on down.
O lovers, let's go down,
down to the river to pray.

Reading: This Body, The River — Heid Erdrich

The River — Music/lyrics by Garth Brooks & Victoria Shaw; arr., Jeff Funk

Reading: Pre-Occupied — Heid Erdrich

The Water is Wide — Traditional folk song, arr., Craig Hella Johnson

River Song (World Premiere) — Music/lyrics by Charles Thomas Betz

Reading: Surface Tension — Heid Erdrich
(new work completed for this concert)

Deep River — Spiritual, arr., Norman Luboff

Reading: Kindred River — Heid Erdrich

At the River — Folk hymn, arr., Aaron Copland & Willing White

Reading: Red River of the North — Heid Erdrich

Mighty Water from "Big River" — Music/lyrics by Roger Miller; arr., John Leavitt

Let the River Run (reprise)
Audience sings when invited

Mississippi run, take all our dreams into your waters,
Ever may she roll along.
From Itasca's shores, she gathers strength and starts her journey.
Mississippi carries our song.

DONATIONS

CRESCENDO
SINGING FOR JOY

Crescendo Community Chorus is a nonprofit—financial gifts are essential to our operations. Use the QR Code, website, or envelope to donate. Thank you!

crescendochorus.org

We heartily thank these donors who have made contributions since our last concert.

Janet Avery
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Friends of Crescendo make significant gifts to Crescendo Community Chorus and its future.

Randal Buikema
Ben & Laura Cooper
Kathy & Chuck Coskran
Bob Friedman & Debbie Cash
Nancy Gaschott & Mark Ritchie
Gail Griffin
Lori Hintz
Steve Hintz
Ann Kay
Jared and Nancy Kieling
Fawzia Khan & Blair Anderson
Ellen Kluz
Bill McTeer
Warren & Patti Park
Karen Parson
Lawrence Pry
Jim Ramnaraine & Tina Wade
Susan Schultz & Weld Ransom
Becky & John Shockley
June & Alan Sroufe
Lynne Stanley
John Welsh
Claire Wilson

FRIENDS OF THE MISSISSIPPI RIVER

Friends of the Mississippi (FMR) is a nonprofit organization located in St. Paul, MN. Become a member today to support FMR's work!

FMR.org

A special thank you to:

Stage Director: Weld Ransom
Lighting: Owen Hewitt
Sound: Nick Wright
Video: Jason Schumacher
Visual: Charles Betz, Fawzia Khan
Text: Alice Golter, Richard Rames
New lyrics: Shelley Des Islets
Ushers: Bill McTeer
Facilities: Adam Borgstahl
Center for Performing Arts
DeLaSalle High School
Allegra Printers

Please attend our next concert, Thursday, November 13, 2025!